leading nobles from their headquarters at Kabul, Qandahar, Lahore, Multan, Delhi, Agra, Etawa, Kalpi, Kol and Sambhal'. These noblemen were entrusted with overcoming Afghan and other local resistance, and attempting to establish some form of regular administration. These high nobles were also assigned a jagir, or revenue assignment, which usually lay within the territory they commanded. This was not a perfect overlay, however, for the area commanded far exceeded the extent of the jagir.

Nor was the situation within the Mughal army free from misgivings. Many from within the soldiery were disenchanted with the plains of Hindustan and yearned to return to the green mountains of Kabul and so, 'to placate the self-sacrificing heroes who had recently entered India', a summons was sent to Kabul to bring the imperial harem and also 'the wives and families of the other attendants…as quickly as possible…so that the men would settle there…' The men may have won the battles, but the women and children were needed to create a haven and a place of comfort.

Since Akbar was a minor at the time, the Mughal Empire needed a regent, or wakil. Bairam Khan was deemed most suitable by the nobility and was appointed wakil-e-saltanat, with the title khankhanan, and Tardi Beg immediately handed over the custody of Mirza Kamran's second son, Abu'l Qasim, to Bairam Khan. Abu'l Qasim was an important hostage because as a Timurid mirza himself, he could become the locus of potentially fractious noblemen. Of immediate concern was Sikandar Shah Sur, one of the Sur pretenders, who had indulged in the boldest posturing and so the imperial army, under Bairam Khan, decided to neutralize him first. Sikandar Shah retreated towards the Sivalik mountains; the army followed him and remained in the area, hunting and accepting the fealty of the zamindars who submitted to the Padshah. Then the imperial army moved back to Jalandhar in the Punjab, during the monsoon of 1556, when news arrived of another turbulent mirza. Mirza Sulaiman was the descendant of a Timurid prince who had submitted to Babur decades previously and who had been given the fief of Badakhshan when Humayun rode back to Hindustan. Now with Humayun dead, Mirza Sulaiman almost capriciously decided to lay claim to Kabul, which was then being controlled by Munim Khan. But in October, news arrived of a much more discordant uprising, one with dreams of empire, for Hemu, a general from Adil Shah's (a Sur descendant) army, had defeated the Mughal forces and had taken Delhi. As soon as he heard of the death of Humayun, while Akbar was still